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General Comment

As a person working in a creative field (illustration and comic book art in my case) I am very worried about the push from many AI and tech companies to be allowed to ignore copyright when training their models.

AI companies are arguing that it should be fair use to take the work we create and post online (either for promotion or for profit) to create images that will compete directly with us. This is already starting to have an effect in the book cover market and in art made for video games, and while it hasn't yet had much of an impact on comics it feels like it will only be a matter of time. I do not think the things AI can create will ever be very good, but I do worry that the draw of not having to pay someone for their work will be irresistible. We could end up in a situation where the next generation of artists (or, to bring up another field, the next generation of coders) never get the opportunity to develop their skills. We could lose our culture to a flood of averaged images, bland text, and incomprehensible software if we're not careful.

Simply put: AI is just code, not a person. It certainly has applications, including in creative fields, but it is no where near the point where it can replace humans, if that's ever desirable. We should be very careful about how much power we give a statistical model over the art we interact with and the software we use every day.